Systematic 12-Lead ECG Interpretation Handbook

Step-by-step 12-lead ECG analysis guide covering rate calculation, cardiac axis, bundle branch blocks, STEMI localizations, and ventricular arrhythmias.

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1. Systematic ECG Reading Framework

A disciplined 7-step method prevents missed pathology: 1) Rate (300 divided by number of large boxes between R-R intervals), 2) Rhythm (sinus vs ectopic), 3) Cardiac Axis (Lead I and aVF analysis: normal -30 to +90 deg), 4) PR Interval (120-200 ms), 5) QRS duration (< 120 ms), 6) ST Segment elevation/depression, and 7) T wave morphology.

2. Acute Coronary Syndrome Localizations

ST-elevation myocardial infarction (STEMI) localizes anatomically according to lead groupings: Anterior wall infarction involves Leads V1-V4 (LAD artery); Lateral wall infarction involves Leads I, aVL, V5, V6 (Left Circumflex); Inferior wall infarction involves Leads II, III, aVF (Right Coronary Artery).